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One are the days when open source solutions were considered the play tools of geeks. Over time, open source tools and technologies have emerged as powerful, scalable, flexible, and most importantly, economical alternatives to popular commercial software.

The word is spreading, and spreading very fast—and why not! After all, open source is business-ready now, and offers a rich mix of platforms and solutions to businesses of all sizes, across verticals. Technologies like cloud computing and virtualisation promise better returns on investment. And, if you add the open source element to the

recipe, you might be able to achieve your goals without ever having to bother the finance guys!

Considering the benefits that open source can render to businesses, the agenda of last year's edition of Open Source India 2010 focused on the theme: 'Open Source is Business-Ready'.

As we stand at the threshold of the 2011 edition of Open Source India (<http://osidays.com>), we thought the time was just right to look back and ask the previous year's attendees to share their experiences, their take on the difference that open source can make to businesses, and a few words on what they expect from the next edition of the event. Here goes...